

The two additional questions I came up with for my data set were 10: Which universities receive the most applications? And 11: Which degree type has the highest average GPA?

I was curious to answer Question 10 because, as a graduate student myself, I spent significant time researching graduate programs and their acceptance rates during the application process. However, acceptance rates alone do not always reflect the overall popularity or demand for a program. A university may have a higher acceptance rate than a peer institution but still receive substantially more applications. For example, my alma mater, the University of Maryland, had an acceptance rate of approximately 20% when I was an undergraduate student, yet it received a much larger volume of applications than some Ivy League institutions. Therefore, I was interested in identifying which universities in the GradCafe dataset received the highest number of applications, as this provides additional insight into applicant interest beyond acceptance rates alone.

I was curious about question 11, which degree has the highest GPA, because before applying to grad school I was considering doing a MS or a JD focusing on Tech Law. I measured the rigor of the acceptance process by the average entrance exam scores and average GPAs at the time of acceptance so I found this question relevant.